Analyzing Netflix's Content Strategy

A Quantitative Study of Catalog Composition and Predictive Classification

MIS-581 Capstone
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Good afternoon. Today I will be presenting my capstone research analyzing Netflix's content strategy using quantitative analytics. Because proprietary performance data is unavailable, this study evaluates publicly available metadata to identify strategic patterns in content type distribution, genre concentration, and predictive classification capabilities

Overview

- Business Problem & Purpose
- Dataset & Tools
- Research Questions & Hypotheses
- Findings
  - Content Type Trends
  - Genre Distribution
  - Predictive Modeling
- Strategic Implications & Recommendations
- Limitations & Future Research

Today I will be discussing the Business Problem & Purpose
Dataset & Tools
Research Questions & Hypotheses
Findings
Content Type Trends
Genre Distribution
Predictive Modeling
Strategic Implications & Recommendations
Limitations & Future Research

Business Problem and Purpose

- Streaming market is highly competitive
- Content strategy drives competitive advantage
- Limited access to proprietary performance metrics
- Objective: Analyze publicly available metadata to identify strategic patterns

Netflix operates in an increasingly competitive streaming environment where content decisions directly affect subscriber growth and retention. However, external analysts do not have access to internal metrics like viewership or revenue per title. This creates a visibility gap in understanding Netflix's strategic direction. The purpose of this study was to determine whether publicly available metadata could serve as a proxy for identifying content strategy trends

Dataset & Tools

Dataset:

- Public Netflix title-level metadata
- Variables: content type, release year, runtime, genre, rating

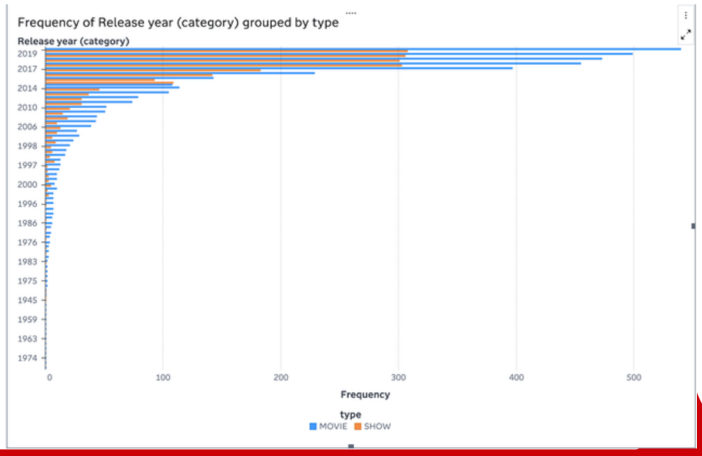
Tools Used:

- SAS Studio
- SAS Visual Analytics
- Chi-square tests
- Logistic regression
- Decision Tree

This study used a publicly available dataset consisting of one observation per Netflix title. Key variables included content type, release year, runtime, and genre classification. Analysis was conducted in SAS Studio and SAS Visual Analytics. I applied descriptive statistics, chi-square testing for hypothesis evaluation, and predictive modeling using logistic regression and decision trees.

The Three research questions are Has Netflix increasingly added more television shows than movies over time?
Which genres appear most frequently in Netflix's content catalog?
Can content attributes such as genre, duration, and release year predict whether a title is classified as a movie or a television show? Based on these questions, this study tested three primary hypotheses. First, whether Netflix has shifted toward adding more television shows than movies. Second, whether genre distribution is uniform or strategically concentrated. Third, whether metadata attributes such as runtime and genre can predict whether a title is a movie or show. Each hypothesis was tested using formal statistical methods

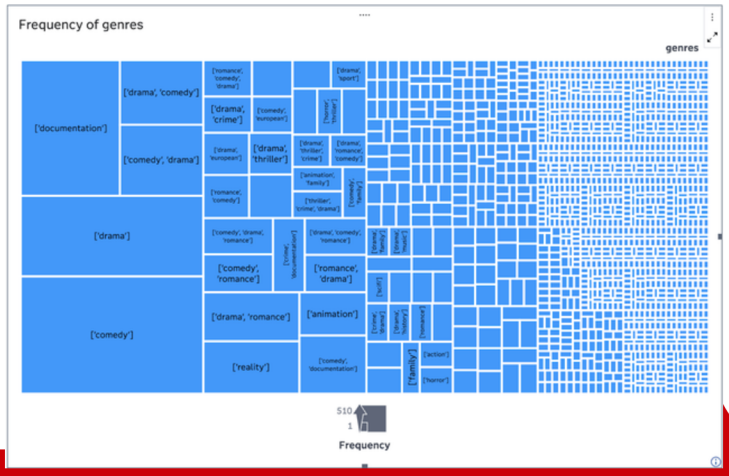
Findings: Content Type Trends



- Movies consistently outnumber shows
- Growth for both after 2014
- No structural reversal

Although both movies and television shows increased significantly between 2014 and 2019, movies consistently outnumbered shows in every observed year. Therefore, we failed to reject the null hypothesis. Netflix expanded television investment but did not shift away from a movie-dominant catalog.

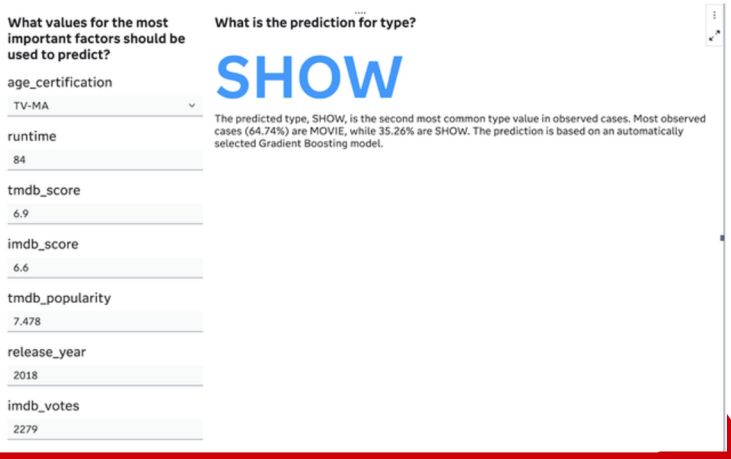
Findings: Genre Distribution



- Comedy, drama, documentary dominate
- Uneven distribution
- Strategic concentration evident

The treemap reveals a highly uneven genre distribution. Comedy, drama, and documentary account for the largest share of titles. This supports rejection of the null hypothesis and suggests deliberate prioritization of broad-appeal genres that maximize global reach and engagement

Findings: Predictive Modeling



- Genre + runtime + release year significant
- Model successfully classifies content type
- Metadata provides predictive value

The predictive model demonstrates that content classification is not random. Structured metadata attributes significantly predict whether a title is a movie or television show. Therefore, we rejected the null hypothesis. This confirms metadata's strategic and analytical value

Strategic Implications & Recommendations

- Maintain diversified content mix
- Optimize genre balance
- Leverage predictive analytics for content planning
- Expand underrepresented genres strategically

These findings suggest Netflix should continue leveraging metadata analytics for strategic planning. While movies dominate, serialized growth supports diversification. Genre concentration supports engagement but presents differentiation risk. Predictive modeling can support acquisition and production decisions before content investment

Limitations & Future Research

Limitations:

- No performance metrics
- Observational design
- Multi-genre ambiguity

Future Research:

- Integrate viewership data
- Longitudinal lifecycle analysis
- Cross-platform comparison

This study is limited by lack of engagement and revenue data, restricting causal inference. Future research should integrate internal performance metrics and examine content lifecycle trends. Expanding analysis across multiple streaming platforms would provide industry-wide comparative insight.

NETFLIX
NARCOS
ORANGE BLACK
GODLESS
Trolls
Rick and Morty
BRIGHT
STRANGER THINGS
CROWN
shameless
MOANA

Thank You!

Resources

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